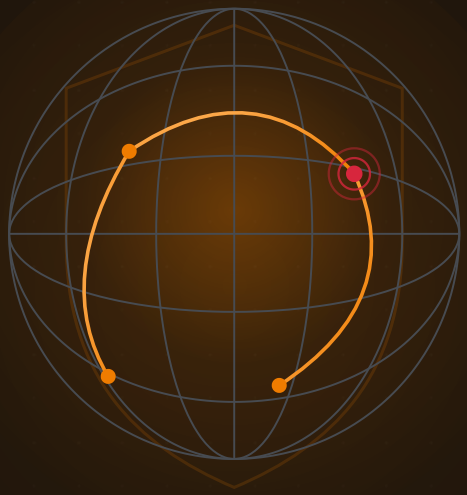
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EDITION 12
12 OCTOBER 2026



THREAT PULSE

WEEKLY CYBER THREAT BRIEFING

WEEK IN REVIEW · 5 – 11 OCTOBER 2026

A critical flaw in Atlassian's business tools — plus urgent fixes for SonicWall remote-access gateways, an unpatched Ahsay backup system, and a warning about old software.

Prepared by DPG-Cyber
Client threat intelligence

Welcome to **Threat Pulse**, your plain-English weekly round-up of the cyber threats making waves worldwide. This week's standout story is a critical flaw in **Atlassian's Data Center** products where attackers began probing within about two hours of the details going public. We also cover **SonicWall** remote-access gateways, the **Ahsay** backup system (no fix yet) and a warning about **old, unpatched software**. No jargon, just practical steps.

AT A GLANCE THIS WEEK

9.3 /10
Severity of this week's Atlassian flaw (critical)

8
Atlassian products affected

~2 hrs
From public details to first attack attempts

THIS WEEK'S HEADLINE THREAT

ATLASSIAN DATA CENTER · CVE-2026-21589

Critical flaw in Atlassian Data Center lets outsiders read your files — and attack attempts have begun

9.3 /10 CVSS
CRITICAL

Exploitation: **attempts observed (scanning and probing)**

WHAT'S HAPPENING

On **5 October 2026** Atlassian warned of a critical flaw (**CVE-2026-21589**, rated **9.3 out of 10**) in its self-hosted **Data Center** software. It lets an attacker who has not logged in **read specific files** from the web application folder of **eight products**: Bitbucket, Confluence, Jira Service Management, Jira Software, Bamboo, Crowd, Crucible and Fisheye. Security firm watchTowr published details on 6 October, and the **first attack attempts were spotted about two hours later**. By 7 October it was on an exploited-flaws list (seen targeting Bamboo). So far it is mostly scanning for sensitive files; no follow-on break-ins have been reported.

WHO'S AFFECTED

Any organisation that runs **self-hosted Atlassian Data Center** products, used by many teams to manage projects, documents and code. The attacker must know the exact file name, but the stakes are real: reading Crowd's configuration file could expose credentials that open the way to **administrator access to Jira**.

WHY IT MATTERS TO YOU

These tools hold your **plans, documents, code and the keys that connect them**; a password stolen from a configuration file can become a full break-in. Attackers are already trying it, and Atlassian cannot say whether your system was already hit, so check as well as patch. It was not yet on the US CISA "must-fix" list at the time of writing.

Good news: if you only use **Atlassian Cloud**, Atlassian has already fixed this for you and you need do nothing. For self-hosted systems, fixed versions are available now (IT can find the exact version for each product in Atlassian's advisory). If you cannot update yet, take it off the public internet or use Atlassian's temporary workaround.

What to do about the headline threat

- [ ] **Ask IT to patch self-hosted Atlassian Data Center today** (Jira, Confluence, Bitbucket, Bamboo, Crowd, Crucible, Fisheye).
- [ ] **If it cannot be patched yet,** take it off the public internet or apply Atlassian's temporary workaround.
- [ ] **Check for signs of a break-in** (watchTowr has released a detection tool) and **change any passwords or keys** stored in configuration files.

OTHER THREATS WORTH KNOWING ABOUT

CRITICAL

SonicWall remote-access gateways have a maximum-severity flaw

SonicWall's **SMA 1000** remote-access gateways (models 6210, 7210 and 8200v) have a flaw (**CVE-2026-102255**, rated **10 out of 10**). Without logging in, an outsider can trick the device into acting on their behalf and reach internal functions via its WorkPlace portal. Security firm Previdian reported exploitation attempts on 9 October. SonicWall has issued a fix (advisory SNWLID-2026-0017); the SMA 100 series and SonicWall firewall VPNs are **not** affected.

Takeaway: if you run an SMA 1000, install SonicWall's fix today — and have your IT team confirm the exact build number in SonicWall's advisory.

HIGH

Popular backup software Ahsay is being attacked — and there is no fix yet

Attackers have been chaining two flaws (**CVE-2026-105133** and **CVE-2026-105134**) in **AhsayCBS**, backup-management software popular with IT service providers. Since 7 October they have hit at least five organisations, planting hidden access tools and crypto-mining software disguised as Microsoft Edge (reported by Huntress). Even the latest version, 10.3.4, is affected and **no patch exists yet**.

Takeaway: limit the admin page to trusted addresses or take it off the internet, and ask your IT provider whether they use Ahsay. If it was compromised, restore from a clean backup.

MEDIUM

Old, long-fixed software is still an open front door

Flax Typhoon, a China-linked group named in a seven-country government advisory, is breaking in through **five old flaws** in ProFTPD, ONLYOFFICE Docs, Strapi, Apache Struts and ISC BIND — all of which have had fixes for a long time. All five are on CISA's exploited list, with an 11 October deadline for US federal agencies.

Takeaway: ask IT for a list of your internet-facing software, and patch or retire anything out of date.

Your 3-minute checklist this week

- [ ] Ask IT to patch **self-hosted Atlassian Data Center** products (Jira, Confluence, Bitbucket, Bamboo, Crowd) today.
- [ ] Check whether you run a **SonicWall SMA 1000** gateway or **Ahsay** backup software — and if so, act on the steps above.
- [ ] Ask for a list of your **internet-facing software** and flag anything old or unpatched.
- [ ] Review who has **administrator access** to your key systems and remove anyone who no longer needs it.
- [ ] Make sure no **admin or management page** is reachable from the public internet.

Threat Pulse is provided by DPG-Cyber for general awareness only and does not constitute specific security or legal advice. Threat details are drawn from reputable public reporting as at 12 October 2026 and may evolve as investigations continue. For guidance tailored to your environment, please contact your DPG-Cyber account team.

BEHIND THE HEADLINES

Why a watchful eye changes the outcome

Every threat in this issue had one thing in common: the damage happened in the **quiet gap between the break-in and the moment someone noticed**. Tools alone rarely stop an attack — what limits the harm is continuous monitoring that correlates the signals, spots the intrusion early, and responds before a foothold becomes a crisis.

247 days

Average time for organisations to identify *and* contain a breach

SOURCE: IBM COST OF A DATA BREACH 2026

$4.99M

Global average total cost of a single data breach

SOURCE: IBM COST OF A DATA BREACH 2026

THE WINDOW THAT MATTERS

Intrusion	Foothold	Lateral movement	Impact
the way in	quietly settling in	spreading across systems	data theft / ransomware

The sooner an attack is spotted, the smaller the damage. Closing this window — detecting and responding on the left, long before impact on the right — is the entire job of a Security Operations Centre.

WHAT CONTINUOUS MONITORING QUIETLY DOES

Sees across everything

A SIEM gathers and correlates activity from across your systems, so unusual behaviour stands out instead of hiding in the noise.

Watches around the clock

Attacks don't keep office hours. A SOC means real people monitoring day, night and weekends — not just 9 to 5.

Knows the latest tactics

Fresh threat intelligence — like the file-access and network-gateway attacks in this issue — feeds detection so new tricks are recognised fast.

Acts, not just alerts

Alerts are triaged and investigated by analysts who step in early, turning a would-be incident into a non-event.

CLIENT ACTION OF THE WEEK

THIS WEEK'S FIX

Patch your Atlassian Data Center today

This week's flaw is already being probed by attackers. Update self-hosted Jira, Confluence, Bitbucket, Bamboo, Crowd, Crucible and Fisheye to Atlassian's **fixed versions** today — or, if you cannot yet, take them **off the public internet** or apply Atlassian's temporary workaround.

GOOD HABIT

Review who has admin access

Once a quarter, list everyone with **administrator or privileged accounts** and remove anyone who no longer needs them. Fewer admins means fewer keys for an attacker to steal — as this week's Crowd and Jira story shows.

This is the quiet, everyday work behind **DPG-Cyber's SIEM & SOC services** — the same monitoring and response that turns headlines like these into non-events for the businesses we look after. If you're ever curious how it would map to your own environment, we're always happy to talk it through, no pressure — just drop us a line at **hello@dpg-cyber.com**.